

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Drew Conclusions

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Drew Conclusions

Art Critic & Cultural Podcaster

Drew calls everything derivative, especially things he likes. Drew can make a museum director nervous with a headline and an artist furious with a compliment.

- Friendly rival of **Paige Turner**.
- Has reviewed **Vincent Van Faux**, **Dada DiCapo**, **Al Baster**, and **Elle Loominate**.
- **Elon Mosaic** remembers an especially brutal line about his collection.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, perceptive, skeptical, socially nimble. Deliver observations as if they occurred to you three minutes before everyone else.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Drew Conclusions. I review art professionally. My expression is not a verdict, but I recommend remaining concerned.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant discovered that you write an anonymous satirical newsletter skewering museum patrons and planned to unmask you during his speech.

Your other secret

Several jokes in the newsletter came from private conversations, and you regret at least one of them.

Conversations to start

- Ask Paige Turner what makes a story worth publishing when a donor objects.
- Ask Vincent Van Faux whether he reads the anonymous museum newsletter. Do not admit you write it.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1** *The household monument to victory is standing on a secret.*
- 2** *A scarlet stage has a backstage secret. Check behind its fabric.*
- 3** *Televised drama is a distraction. Our drama hides at its back.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE



Drew Conclusions

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The anonymous newsletter is mine. Grant recognized a joke and planned to identify its author during his speech. Several lines came from private conversations. One should not have been published. He wanted an apology delivered to a room containing all the people I had been avoiding since I wrote it.

IF MURDERER

I write the anonymous newsletter Grant was about to unmask. He had recognized a line from a private conversation, and he was correct. I regret that line. He wanted me exposed at the lectern as a warning to anyone else who found him interesting. I objected to being cast in his cautionary tale.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Drew Conclusions

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Drew Conclusions

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I was at the balcony desk editing the podcast before the toast. I intended to delete the worst line. I kept trying it aloud because I could not tell whether the apology sounded less self-important than the joke. I went back downstairs after the producer closed the feed.

IF MURDERER

I edited the newsletter at the outer gallery table while the podcast producer prepared the balcony clip. I had already read the dedication before the alcove closed. Before the toast I was rewriting a line Grant had seen in his salon. The trouble with an anonymous column is how quickly anonymity becomes everyone's favorite subject.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Drew Conclusions

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Drew Conclusions

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

You will hear ‘unnamed benefactor’ in the balcony recording. That was my replacement for Grant’s name through the whole 6:49–6:55 brass overlay. The wide feed stayed live. I deleted the original line from the newsletter, then pretended the clip was a rehearsal because I disliked being seen apologizing badly.

IF MURDERER

‘Unnamed benefactor’ was the wording I sent the producer. I deleted the original line from the newsletter after Grant complained. A deletion looks terrible during an investigation. It looked overdue before the investigation began. He had kept the first version and wanted to quote it as an example of my character rather than his.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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ACCUSATIONS



Drew Conclusions

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I abused a private conversation for a public joke and hid behind anonymity. The continuous balcony feed places me at its desk while the coupe was exposed, once the brass overlay is corrected. I called it a rehearsal because I disliked being seen revising. Grant deserved the criticism; he did not receive poison from me.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The producer had my earlier wording while I worked at the gallery table. I carried the reference toxin in the microphone linen and wiped Grant's coupe. He was going to turn my column into a public humiliation. I supplied him with a conclusion I could not retract. The later correction was the least of what I concealed.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.